

The war machine

Alexander led his army to one victory after another. They swept across Asia Minor, Syria, and Egypt before finally defeating the Persian king, Darius, at the **Battle of Gaugamela** in 331 BCE. At the age of 25, Alexander was **king of Macedonia** , leader of the Greeks, overlord of Asia Minor, pharaoh of Egypt, and **"GREAT KING"** of Persia. This map shows Alexander's empire at its peak.



The legend

Alexander was surrounded by many **MYTHS AND LEGENDS** . One legend says that he heard of a prophecy that foretold that whoever untied the (impossible) **Gordian knot** would rule all of Asia. Alexander's solution was to simply hack through the knot with his sword. Another myth says he was the **son of Zeus** .

Did you know?

Alexander founded or renamed more than 70 cities—many of them were called "Alexandria," after himself.

Master strategist

Alexander was a **BRILLIANT GENERAL** . At the Battle of Issus in 333 BCE, his **40,000 men faced 100,000 Persians** on ground that suited the enemy. Even though Alexander was wounded, **his army won the day** , and the Persian king, Darius III, had to flee.



West meets East

Alexander died when he was just 32. However, his legacy includes a vast empire that spread western culture as far as India, and opened trade routes that would last for centuries.

BUCEPHALUS (355–326 BCE) was Alexander's war horse, which he rode to some of his greatest victories. When he died, Alexander named a city, **BUCEPHALIA** , after him.



PTOLEMY (323–282 BCE) was Alexander's close childhood friend and **LOYAL GENERAL** . When Alexander died, Ptolemy became pharaoh of Egypt.

